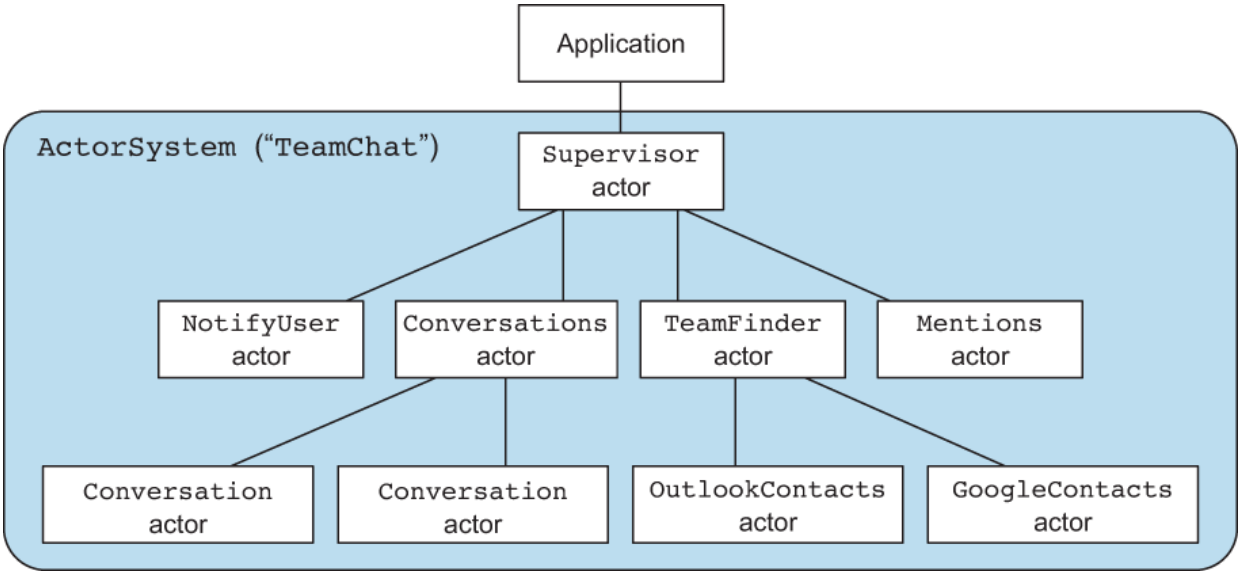


Figure 1.20 `TeamChat ActorSystem`

We've touched on the fact that you need support capabilities for actors, like remoting and a journal for durability. The `ActorSystem` is also the nexus for these support capabilities. Most capabilities are provided as *Akka extensions*: modules that can be configured specifically for the `ActorSystem` in question. A simple example of a support capability is the scheduler, which can send messages to actors according to a specific schedule.

An `ActorSystem` returns an address to the created top-level actor instead of the actor itself. This address is called an `ActorRef`. The `ActorRef` can be used to send messages to the actor. This makes sense when you think about the fact that the actor could be on another server.

Sometimes you'd like to look up an actor in the actor system. This is where `ActorPaths` come in. You can compare the hierarchy of actors to a URL path structure. Every actor has a name. This name